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The Seven Seals in the Writings of Joachim of Fiore: With Special Reference to the Tract "De Septem Sigillis"

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Source: *Recherches de théologie ancienne et médiévale*, Juillet-Décembre 1954, Vol. 21 (Juillet-Décembre 1954), pp. 211-247

Published by: Peeters Publishers

Stable URL: <https://www.jstor.org/stable/26186211>

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The Seven Seals in the Writings of Joachim of Fiore

With Special Reference to the Tract
De Septem Sigillis.

As evidence accumulates to show the widespread dissemination of Joachimist ideas in the thirteenth century, — and even in the first half of the century ¹, — the question arises as to the chief forms in which Joachim's ideas were popularised. His three main works are found in a fair number of manuscripts ², but not many have survived from the thirteenth century ³ and, in any case, two of the three are lengthy and complicated, with much repetition and elaboration of Joachim's key ideas. Recent studies, — already anticipated by Holder-Egger ⁴, — have called attention to prophetic anthologies, to figure collections and to short tracts, as propagators of Joachimism ⁵.

1. Some of the evidence for this period will be discussed by M. REEVES and M. W. BLOOMFIELD in a forthcoming article in *Speculum* 29 (1954), entitled *On the Penetration of Joachimism into Northern Europe*.

2. Listed by H. DENIFLE, in *Archiv f. Literatur- u. Kirchengesch. d. Mittelalt.* 1 (1885) p. 90 ff., with additions by H. GRUNDMANN, *Studien über Joachim von Floris*, Leipzig, 1927, p. 17, n. 1.

3. Those so far identified are: (1) *Liber Concordie*: Vat. Lat. 4861; Rome Bibl. Corsiniana 41. F. 2; Padua Bibl. Antoniana 328; Florence Bibl. Laur. Plut. XXVIII Dextr. XI (Bk. V only); Paris Nat. 15254, 10453, 16280; Troyes 249; Bamberg A. 11.50; Dresden A. 121. (2) *Expositio in Apocalypsim*: Vat. Chig. A. VIII. 231; Pavia Bibl. Univers. Aldinus 370; Paris Nat. 427 (Lib. Introd. only); Troyes 249. (3) *Psalterium decem cordarum*: Padua Bibl. Anton. 322; Paris Nat. 427; Dresden A. 121.

4. O. HOLDER-EGGER, *Italienische Prophetien des 13. Jahrhunderts*, in *Neues Archiv* 15 (1889) p. 143-178; 30 (1904-05) p. 323-386; 33 (1907-08) p. 97-187.

5. J. BIGNAMI-ODIER, *Notes sur deux manuscrits de la Bibliothèque du Vatican contenant des traités inédits de Joachim de Flore*, in *Mélanges d'Archéol. et d'Hist.* 54 (1937) p. 211-241; L. TONDELLI, *Il Libro delle Figure dell' Abate Gioachino da Fiore*, 2nd ed., Torino, 1953, vol. I; M. REEVES, *The Liber Figurarum of Joachim of Fiore*, in *Mediaeval and Renaissance Studies* 2 (1950) p. 57-81; M. REEVES, B. HIRSCH-REICH, *ibid.* 3 (1954) p. 171-199; J. C. HUCK, *Joachim von Floris u. die joachitische Literatur*, Freiburg i. Br., 1938.

Two possible reasons for the popularity of such material may be suggested: first, interest was focussed on precisely that aspect of Joachim's thought which best lent itself to this type of treatment, namely, his schemes of history and prophecies of the future (including, as time passed, the spurious prophecies circulating under his name); secondly, simplification of the intricate patterns woven by the abbot in his main works was probably much needed by those who sought impatiently to know what he really forecast for the future. In some cases these figures and short tracts appeared in conjunction with the longer works, sometimes apart from them; in any case, they probably show us the essentially popular elements in Joachim's thought.

The most important of the figure-collections, the *Liber Figurarum*, focuses attention upon a hitherto unnoticed aspect of Joachim's thought, namely, his use of *alternative* patterns of 'twos' and 'threes' in his interpretation of history. This sends one back to the main writings prepared to recognise certain key-passages which had previously been passed over. Thus on f. 7^r of the *Liber Concordie*⁶ Joachim begins to deal with concords between the Old and New Testaments, but on f. 8^v he is already introducing his pattern of three *status* and three orders. That these are alternative but mystically connected ways of viewing history becomes clear only from a study of such passages as the following which are key explanations embedded in detailed expositions:

Quia due Persone sunt quarum una ingenita est alia genita, Persone ingenite ascribenda sunt opera testamenti primi cuius tempus ab Adam usque ad Christum: Persone genite opera testamenti secundi cuius tempus ab Ozia usque ad consummationem seculi... Quia vero una Persona est que ex duabus procedit et ipsa Spiritus Sanctus dicta est ascribenda sunt eidem Persone quedam specialia opera que ex aliis processerunt. ...Prima diffinitio designatur in A quod est elementum triangulatum. Secunda designatur in (O) in quo virgula de medio duarum procedit (*Lib. Conc.*, f. 10^r).

Propter illa que dicta sunt superius de sacro mysterio Trinitatis duplicem esse diximus causam concordie secundum quod tres esse diximus ordines electorum et duos populos vocatos ad fidem. Diximus etiam quod in prima assignatione concordie incipiendum ab Adam et desinendum in Christo: incipiendum est ab Ozia et desinendum in temporibus istis: incipiendum a temporibus Sancti Benedicti et desinendum in consummatione seculi. In secunda assignatione incipiendum est ab Adam sicut super et desinendum in Christo: incipiendum ab Ozia rege iuda et desinendum in consummatione seculi (*Lib. Conc.*, f. 13^v).

Ex duplici causa concordiarum questio mota est et decisa ostendente nobis veritate que ait Ego sum Alpha et Omega: quod et propter equali-

6. All references to the *Liber Concordie* and the *Expositio in Apocalypsim* are to the editions printed in Venice in 1519 and 1527.

tatem Personarum tres ordines electi sunt a principio tribus temporibus specialiter deputati : et propter auctoritatem patris et nativitatem filii duo populi electi sunt ad fidem unius Dei sub duobus testamentis, Judaicus videlicet et Gentilis... Iam igitur ostensa causa et assignata ratione de utraque concordia, primo quidem de prima diffinitione agere incipimus, inchoantes ab Adam et ab Ozia et pervenientes usque ad Christum et usque ad hec tempora nostra : deinde secundum aliam diffinitionem usque ad consummationem seculi (*Lib. Conc.*, f. 19^r).

In the *Liber introductorius* of the *Expositio in Apocalypsim* the alternative patterns of twos and threes are even more explicitly stated. Cap. 6 is headed *Assignatio concordie duorum testamentorum* and opens thus :

Si secundum quod se mutuis vultibus duo que scriptura sepe commemorat testamenta respiciunt, concordiam duorum temporum volumus assignare, primus temporis cursus a Jacob patriarcha inchoandus est et terminandus in Christo, secundus a Christo usque ad finem seculi... Sin vero quia Testamentum novum geminum est et quasi duplex... tempus istud quod dicitur gratie in duas temporum portiones distinguitur : ... invenimus in tribus statibus magna quedam opera Domini distincta proprietatibus suis in quibus trinam concordiam oporteat assignari, salvo intellectu superiori et prima illa assignatione que duo velut ex equo testamento concordat (*Expos. in Apoc.*, f. 6^{r-v}).

Cap. 7 is headed *De secunda assignatione concordie* and begins :

Nunc dicendum est aliquid de concordia... que in tribus statibus consistit. Propter illam namque concordiam dictum est in evangelio : Erant ibi hydie lapidee sex posite capientes singule metretas binas propter istam additum est vel ternas. Utrumque enim ut iam diximus necessarium est. Unde cum Dominus vellet ostendere quot homines essent sufficientes ad testimonium, In ore, inquit, duorum aut trium testium stabit omne verbum. Quia ergo audivimus testimonium duorum, necesse est ut addito tertio audiamus et trium. Et quia orbi ostendimus duo tempora distincta certis metis et operibus suis, necesse est ut hic assignemus et tria (*Expos. in Apoc.*, f. 9^r).

The importance of this distinction between the two ways of looking at history lies chiefly in their alternative views of the end of history. Seen in 'twos', the parallel streams roll straight on to the final tribulation ending each era : *Ibi post Antiochum regem datus est finis veteri testamento. Hic post adventum Gog erit consummatio seculi*⁷. Viewed in 'threes', the third status or Sabbath Age must supervene before the end of history, foreshadowed by a sabbath at the end of the first era. Here the main series of tribulations culminates in bliss and all the emphasis is on this blessedness of the third status ; yet still, as a postscript, there comes a final tribulation : *Consummatis autem pres-*

7. *Expos.*, f. 9^r.

*suris illis, adveniet tempus beatum, tempus quod erit simile solennitati paschali... Iste erit tertius status pertinens ad Spiritum Sanctum... Ut autem in fine primi status ultimus rex, Antiochus nomine, ceteris immanior fuit, ita in fine secundi, qui erit in proximo, septimus rex ille venturus est... Sane in fine tertii venturus est alius qui cognominatus est Gog et ipse erit ultimus tyrannus et ultimus antichristus*⁸.

Now in the *Liber Figurarum* it is the pattern of twos that strikes the eye at once and only afterwards does one grasp the partly-concealed pattern of threes. This gives us an important clue to the form in which Joachim's ideas spread which, taken in conjunction with early references to his doctrines, leads to the striking conclusion that it was Joachim's pattern of twos in history rather than his pattern of threes that was first most widely known. The evidence for this has been set out in detail elsewhere⁹. People were interested in his system of concords between the Old and New Testaments before they realised the revolutionary force of his doctrine of the three *status* of mankind. A study of Joachim's writings suggests that this was the right order, that the abbot himself was at first much occupied with the conception of the two great parallel streams of history symbolised by the two Testaments, while later the Trinitarian view of history, — always present in his thought, — came to the fore. Perhaps the germ of his pattern of twos came to him from the Scriptural symbol of 'a Book written within and on the backside, sealed with Seven Seals' (*Apoc.* 5, 1). This stirred his imagination most powerfully; it appears at the very beginning of the *Liber Concordie*¹⁰, in association with the passages quoted above, and remains constantly in his thought. From it he derives his conception of the double sweep of history: the seven periods or seals of the Old Dispensation, each marked off by its appropriate *bellum* or *persecutio*, and the seven parallel periods or *apertiones* of the New Dispensation, with their corresponding persecutions. This gives Joachim the basic scheme of history upon which all others, including the division into three *status*, were built up. It would not

8. *Expos.*, f. 9^v-10^r.

9. M. REEVES, M. W. BLOOMFIELD, *On the Penetration of Joachimism into Northern Europe*, in *Speculum* 29 (1954).

10. On f. 5 of the *Lib. Conc.* there is a fine exhortation to rise from earthly to heavenly vision, ending: *ascende cum eodem angelo in montem magnum et altum et ita poteris videre alta consilia abscondita a diebus antiquis et a generationibus seculorum*. This is quickly followed by the first full reference to the Sealed Book: *inter cetera vero sacra mysteria que oculis spiritualibus contemplatus est Vidi (ait) librum scriptum intus et foris, signatum sigillis septem... Habemus igitur victorem qui aperuit librum. Habemus leonem de tribu iuda qui solvit septem signacula eius. Iam ergo nuda et aperta sunt omnia*. See also *Lib. Conc.*, f. 4^v, 25^r; *Expos.*, f. 3^v, 4^r.

be surprising to find this theme of the Seven Seals and their Openings picked out for separate treatment in tract form. Such a pamphlet might summarise for popular consumption that part of Joachim's system which aroused most immediate interest; it might also form a useful supplement to the *Liber Figurarum*, where the scheme of the Seven Seals is used several times. When, therefore, we meet a short, separate tract on this subject, in close association with the *Liber Figurarum*, there is a strong likelihood that we have here a genuine little work of Joachim's, designed to give a brief and basic scheme of history in an easy form.

Before we turn to this tract, it will be useful to gather together from his writings the schemes of history which Joachim based on the Seven Seals. As we have said, the symbol of the sealed book appears at the outset in the *Liber Concordie*. In Lib. I, cap. 9 (f. 4^v), the history of Israel is divided into seven periods according to the Seven Seals, each marked by the conflict or persecution which it sustained. These are the conflicts with the Egyptians, the Canaanites and Philistines, the Syrians, the Assyrians, the Babylonians, and the sixth and seventh which form one double conflict in the sixth age. This is followed by a 'Sabbath' under the seventh seal when conflict — and history — are suspended until the final tribulation of Antiochus Epiphanes — carefully distinguished from the preceding seven — closes the Old Testament Dispensation¹¹. In the following pages Joachim is developing the second great principle upon which his double scheme of history is constructed — that of the concords between the two Testaments :... *cum... persona et persona, ordo et ordo, bellum et bellum ex parilitate quadam mutuis se vultibus intuentur*¹². Here he plunges into intricate calculations of generations from which he constructs a framework which is constantly used hereafter¹³: the generations are grouped in series of 21 in such a way that the Dispensation of the Old Testament is reckoned as 21 + 21 + 21, while that of the New Testament (which, beginning with Ozias, overlaps the Old by 21 generations) will likewise endure for 63 generations, and beyond, to the *Consummatio Seculi*¹⁴. The intricacy of these calcula-

11. *Lib. Conc.*, f. 5^r. For the significance of this final tribulation, outside the sequence of seven, see below p. 222-223.

12. *Ibid.*, f. 7^{r-v}.

13. It also provides the basic structure in the *Liber Figurarum* of the Tables of Concords and several of the Trees.

14. *Lib. Conc.*, f. 10^v sq. These calculations are accompanied by diagrams of generations which, owing to the exigencies of space, are crammed into the printed edition in such a way as to make them nearly unintelligible. In some MSS. they are properly set out and there are also interesting variations in the diagrams.

tions is in part caused by the fact that Joachim is already seeking to fit his scheme of threes, — which he first adumbrates on f. 8^r-10^r, — into his concords of twos : the three *status* are conceived of as essentially overlapping and this is the reason for the division of each sixty-three into three twenty-ones. In Book III Joachim brings together his basic principles to work out the double division of history into parallel sevens, in which the generations are assigned to each seal, their great men are matched and the conflicts of Israel placed in concord with those of the Church. At the same time the division into threes is not lost to sight. Nothing demonstrates more aptly the need for figures in studying Joachim's system than the fact that the modern student is driven to the construction of the following diagram before the relations of these several divisions is made clear :

COMBINATION OF THE PATTERNS OF TWOS, THREES AND SEVENS.

1 st Status	[Germination]	Adam to Jacob .. 21	Old Testament	} 42 Generations } Seven Seals
63 generations	Fructification	{ Jacob to Ozias .. 21 Ozias to Christ .. 21		
2 nd Status	[Germination]	Christ to Benedict 21		
63 generations	Fructification	{ Benedict to 21	New Testament	} 42 Generations } Seven Openings
3 rd Status	[Germination]	 to Consummatio Seculi		

The scheme for the Seven Seals and their Openings which he lays down in these chapters can be summarised as follows :

- 1st Seal : Abraham to Moses and Joshua ; Conflict with Egyptians.
- 2nd Seal : Joshua to Samuel and David ; Conflict with Canaanites.
- 3rd Seal : David to Elijah and Elisha ; Conflict with Idolaters, Syrians and Philistines ; Schism of Judah and Israel.
- 4th Seal : Elisha to Isaiah and Hezekiah ; Conflict with Assyrians.
- 5th Seal : Hezekiah to Babylonish Captivity ; Conflict with Chaldaeans or Babylonians.
- 6th Seal : Ezechiel to Daniel ; Double Conflict as written in
 - 1 Book of Judith (Assyrians under Nebuchanezzar)
 - 2 Book of Esther (Persians).
- 7th Seal : Sabbath Age.
- 1st Opening : The Apostles ; Conflict with Jews.
- 2nd Opening : Apostles to Constantine ; Conflict with Gentiles or Pagans.
- 3rd Opening : Constantine to Justinian ; Conflict with Arians and Barbarians ; Schism of Latin and Greek Churches.
- 4th Opening : Justinian to Popes Gregory III and Zacharias ; Conflict with Saracens.
- 5th Opening : Zacharias to Emperor Henry III ; Conflict with Germans.
- 6th Opening : Time of conflict with two kings.
- 7th Opening : Sabbath Age.

Throughout these first books of the *Liber Concordie* the emphasis is mainly on the parallelism of history, yet the pattern of threes is always in his mind and it influences his double scheme at two points. One — the calculation of generations in groups of 21 — we have already noticed. The point to which we would now draw attention is the way in which Joachim grapples with the problem of fitting his third *status* of history or Age of the Holy Ghost into his Seven Seals. The connecting link is the idea of the Seventh Seal as a Sabbath Age free from conflict, deriving, of course, from the Seventh Day of Creation. The first, at the end of the Old Testament, is only a foretaste, but the second, at the end of history, will be the true third *status*. Thus, in order to get in seven conflicts, yet keep the seventh age clear, there has to be a double conflict in the sixth age.

Once this scheme of Seals and Openings has been worked out, it forms a constant framework of thought, not only in the *Liber Concordie* but also in the *Expositio in Apocalypsim*¹⁵. Joachim conceives the Apocalypse as falling into eight parts, of which the last represents eternal bliss and the seventh, the Sabbath of the third *status*, while the first six contain the seven conflicts of the Seal Openings which form the second *status*. The basic pattern is restated in the opening pages thus¹⁶:

- 1st Seal: Jacob to Moses and Joshua; Conflict with Egyptians.
- 2nd Seal: Joshua to Samuel and David; Conflict with Canaanites.
- 3rd Seal: David to Elijah and Elisha; Conflict with Syrians.
- 4th Seal: Elisha to Isaiah and Hezekiah; Conflict with Assyrians.
- 5th Seal: Isaiah to the Exile; Conflict with Chaldaeans.
- 6th Seal: Exile to Esther or Malachi; Fall of Old Babylon; Double Conflict:
 - 1 with Assyrians (Judith)
 - 2 with Persians (Esther) or Macedonians.
- 7th Seal: Malachi to Zacharias; Sabbath Age.
- 1st Opening: Zacharias to death of S. John Evangelist; Conflict with Jews.
- 2nd Opening: until Constantine; Conflict with Pagans.
- 3rd Opening: until Justinian; Conflict with Persians, Schism.
- 4th Opening: until Charlemagne; Conflict with 'Agareni'.

15. It is striking to find the same pattern of persecutions (but limited to six) under the Old and New Dispensations worked out in Joachim's most recently published tract *De vita sancti Benedicti et de Officio divino secundum eius doctrinam* (ed. C. BARAUT, in *Analecta Sacra Tarraconensia* 24, 1951, p. 43, 51-54). Here the *bella* are linked with the six nocturnal psalms of the Office and at one point interpreted in terms of battle against different vices.

16. *Expos.*, f. 6^v-12^r. The printed edition of the *Expositio*, in its page headings, only shows six parts, but from the text it is clear that the seventh part begins on f. 209^v and the eighth part on f. 213^r (wrongly numbered 215).

5th Opening : until present time ; Conflict with princes, especially Henry I.

6th Opening : Fall of New Babylon ; Double Conflict (6th and 7th Dragon Heads).

7th Opening : Sabbath Age.

It will be evident that there is remarkably little variation between the schemes in the two main works and when all the references in Joachim's writings are compared, it will be found that the treatment of the first five seals and openings is almost uniform, apart from variations in names. They represent certain interpretations of history from which Joachim does not depart. The interesting points for us occur in the 'openings'. The Barbarians are almost always the Goths, Vandals and Lombards¹⁷. Constantine, together with Pope Sylvester, always represents a moment of peace and glory in the Church¹⁸. Justinian does not receive much attention¹⁹ because, at this point, attention begins to focus on the Schism of the Greek from the Roman Church, typified in the Schism of Israel from Judah²⁰. Rome is the true Church and one consequence of the Schism is the transfer of the Imperium from Byzantium to the Franks, especially to Charlemagne²¹. These first Frankish kings are the friends and protectors of the Roman pontiffs and the Church has peace under them for ten generations²². Finally the Imperium is transferred to the Germans whose kingdom derives from the Franks²³. From the days of the German Emperor Henry I *quibusdam intricatis questionibus angustatur ecclesia*²⁴ and the fifth head of the Dragon is *is qui primus in partibus occiduus cepit fatigare ecclesiam pro investitura ecclesiarum ob quam causam multa scismata et tribulationes orta sunt in eo tempore in ecclesia*²⁵. Thus the Roman Imperium, constituted by God *ad munimen pacis et defensionem ecclesie*²⁶, no longer observes the bounds imposed upon its power by God. Its punishment is symbolised in the sixth angel who pours

17. *Lib. Conc.*, f. 40^r, 47^v-48^v, 50^v, 125^r ; *Expos.*, f. 163^r-^v. See also *De vita sancti Benedicti*, p. 52. *Lib. Conc.*, f. 46^v, mentions with the Goths «Suevi, Marchomanni, Squadi, Heruli, Rugi, Tracilingui».

18. *Lib. Conc.*, f. 17^v, 39^r-^v, 44-45, 52^r, 92^v, 134^v ; *Expos.*, f. 6^v, 9^v, 62^r-^v, 161^v.

19. *Lib. Conc.*, f. 39^v, 45^v, 48^r ; *Expos.*, f. 6^v, 9^v.

20. *Lib. Conc.*, f. 9^r, 17^v, 22^v, 39^v-40^r, 46^r-^v, 52^r ; *Expos.*, f. 7^r-^v, 62^v-63^v, 142^v-143^r.

21. *Lib. Conc.*, f. 40^v-41^r, 45^v, 50^r, 52^r, 89^r ; *Expos.*, f. 6^v, 9^v.

22. *Lib. Conc.*, f. 50^v-51^r.

23. *Lib. Conc.*, f. 41^r, 45^v, 50^v, 52^r-^v ; *Expos.*, f. 7^v.

24. *Lib. Conc.*, f. 41^r. See also *Expos.*, f. 7^v.

25. *Expos.*, f. 196^v.

26. *Expos.*, f. 134^v.

his phial of wrath on the River Euphrates, which dries up²⁷. The Roman Imperium has become Babylon²⁸, and its fall, with the multitude of people involved, cannot be contemplated *sine gemitu*:

...initiatio quedam terribilis iam precessit: super eo scilicet quid nuper accidit: super inclyto illo exercitu Frederici magni et potentissimi Imperatoris et aliis exercitibus populi Christiani, qui transeuntes mare in infinita multitudine, vix in paucis reliquiis pene sine effectu remearunt ad propria (*Expos.*, f. 134^v).

The sixth and seventh seals and openings are usually dealt with at once more fully and more imprecisely. As he considers these crucial and portentous days Joachim's thought wavers and varies, so that it becomes difficult to set it down in summary form as above. This hesitation obviously arises in part from the fact that he is approaching contemporary and future events, but probably also because he is approaching the crucial change from second to third *status*. Joachim's pattern of threes is a more mystical concept than his pattern of twos, which can be worked out by a strictly historical method²⁹; for this reason his treatment of Last Things never descends to the level of prophesying precise events by historical parallels.

There is in the *Expositio*, — and already hinted at in the *Liber Concordie*³⁰, — another scheme of the persecutions of the Church. This is not associated with the seven seals and therefore there are no Old Testament parallels. The idea is of successive persecutions, each associated with one of the four great orders of the Church. Joachim adds a fifth persecution, to be borne by the 'general Church', but he makes no attempt here to complete a sequence of sevens. Nonetheless, the summary given below shows essentially the same plan as that of the Seven Seals and in the *Liber Figurarum*, as we shall see³¹, it is completed to seven.

- | | |
|--|---|
| 1 st Time: Ordo Apostolorum | v. Synagoga Judeorum. |
| 2 nd Time: Ordo Martyrum | v. Cultus Idolorum or Pagans. |
| 3 rd Time: Ordo Doctorum | v. Populus Arrianus or Goths, Vandals
and Lombards. |
| 4 th Time: Ordo Virginum | v. Gens Sarracenorum. |
| 5 th Time: Romana Ecclesia | v. Nova Babylon. |
| | or General Church v. General Multitude of Reprobate ³² . |

27. *Expos.*, f. 190^{r-v}.

28. *Expos.*, f. 173^v-174^r.

29. See M. REEVES, *The Liber Figurarum of Joachim of Fiore*, in *Mediaeval and Renaissance Studies* 2 (1950) p. 77.

30. *Lib. Conc.*, f. 25^v, 125^v.

31. See below, p. 221.

32. This summary is taken from the *Expositio*, f. 24^r, 162^v-170^r.

When we turn to the *Liber Figurarum* ³³ we find that one of the links connecting it most closely with the two main works is its frequent use of the double pattern of sevens. In this we can observe clearly the way in which these figures represent both different stages of Joachim's thought and, in some cases, a final clarification or synthesis. The Tables of Concords are a case in point. In their construction they combine the two main principles upon which Joachim built his scheme of history: the Seven Seals and the parallel generations of men. Here is a synthesis in clear visual form which is never set out so precisely nor with such combination of detail in the *Liber Concordie*. But the two pairs of Tables also reveal different stages in Joachim's thought. As we have seen, the problem of the seven persecutions was how to combine them with the Seven Seals in such a way as to introduce the Seventh Seal or Sabbath Age *after* the seventh and worst tribulation. We have seen how Joachim solved this problem in the two main works; we have also suggested that his thought wavered and changed on this subject of the mysterious sixth and seventh ages. It is, therefore, illuminating to find in the *Liber Figurarum* two different statements of this point. One pair of Tables ³⁴ assigns a persecution to each seal and each opening right up to the seventh seal thus:

<i>Primus Adventus</i>	<i>Secundus Adventus</i>
Sigillum Septimum	Apertio Sigilli Septimi
Persecutio Septima sub Antiocho	Persecutio Septima... Antichristi
Sigillum Sextum	Apertio Sigilli Sexti
Persecutio Sexta Medorum	Sexta Persecutio Decem Regum
Sigillum Quintum	Apertio Sigilli Quinti
Quinta Persecutio Chaldeorum	Quinta Persecutio in qua nunc sumus
Sigillum Quartum	Apertio Sigilli Quarti
Quarta Persecutio Assyriorum	Quarta Persecutio Saracenorum
Sigillum Tertium	Apertio Sigilli Tertii
Tertia Persecutio Syriorum	Tertia Persecutio Gothica, Wandalica, Persica, Longobarda
Sigillum Secundum	Apertio Sigilli Secundi
Secunda Persecutio Madianitarum, Philistinorum, Chananeorum	Secunda Persecutio Paganorum
Sigillum Primum	Apertio Sigilli Primi
Prima Persecutio Egyptiorum	Prima Persecutio Judeorum

Here there is no hint of the Sabbath Ages and the two Dispensations culminate directly in the First and Second Advents. Here is the pa-

33. All references to the *Liber Figurarum* are to the plates in the second edition, vol. II, of *Il Libro delle Figure dell' Abate Gioachino da Fiore*, ed. L. TONDELLI, M. REEVES, B. HIRSCH-REICH, Torino, 1954. The plate numbers of the first edition are the same in the examples quoted here.

34. Pl. IX, X.

rallelism of history — the pattern of twos — expressed in its purest form : the Trinitarian conception of history finds no place.

In the second pair of Tables³⁵, however, Joachim uses the idea of the double sixth conflict, arranging the seal thus :

Sigillum Primum	Apertio Prima
Bella Egyptiorum	Persecutio Judeorum
Sigillum Secundum	Apertio Secunda
Bella Chananeorum	Persecutio Paganorum
Sigillum Tertium	Apertio Tertia
Bella Syriorum	Persecutio Arrianorum
Sigillum Quartum	Apertio Quarta
Bella Assyriorum	Persecutio Arabum, Saracenorum
Sigillum Quintum	Apertio Quinta
Bella Chaldeorum	Persecutio Alamanorum, Romanorum
Sigillum Sextum	Apertio Sexta
Bella Medorum, Persarum, Macedonum	Persecutio Quarti Regis et Decem Regum
Sigillum Septimum	Apertio Septima
Sabbath	Sabbath

These Tables, though retaining in their very form the parallelism of history, thus express implicitly the three-fold interpretation as well. If we term these two pairs of Tables the earlier and the later, it must always be remembered that the later idea appears early in the *Liber Concordie* and that the earlier is preserved in the *Liber Figurarum*, thus emphasising the aspect of 'twos'.

The Dragon figure³⁶ necessarily deals in sevens since there are seven heads, but its subject is the persecutions of the Church and its various orders, not the parallel conflicts of the Old and New Testaments. Hence it uses the alternative scheme of five persecutions given above from the *Expositio*³⁷. Here we see how the exigencies of a figure demand the completion of the sequence, for, in the captions between the seven heads, the five is extended to seven thus :

- First Persecution by Jews in the time of the Apostles.
- Second Persecution by Pagans in the time of the Martyrs.
- Third Persecution by Heretics in the time of the Doctors.
- Fourth Persecution by Saracens in the time of the Virgins.
- Fifth Persecution by Sons of Babylon in the time of the Conventuals.
- Sixth Persecution now begun.
- Seventh Persecution to follow.

35. Pl. III, IV. It will be noted that, whereas the first pair of Tables proceeds upwards, having a skeleton tree form with roots, the second is arranged in a downward sequence.

36. Pl. XIV.

37. See above, p. 219.

There is in the *Liber Figurarum* another figure which gives a simple statement of the double seven persecutions without adding either seals or orders ³⁸. It is arranged in two parallel columns, thus :

Persecutio Egyptiorum	Persecutio Judeorum
Persecutio Philistinorum	Persecutio Paganorum
Persecutio Syrorum	Persecutio Persarum
Persecutio Assyriorum	Persecutio Arabum
Persecutio Chaldeorum	Persecutio Alamannorum
Persecutio Medorum	Persecutio Gentium
Persecutio Grecorum	Persecutio Gog et Magog

Although at first sight so similar to other sequences, there is one significant variant here in the introduction of Gog and Magog, paralleling the Greek persecution. This takes us back to the alternative patterns of twos and threes at the opening of the *Expositio* when, in dealing with the *first* assignation of concords, Joachim, it will be remembered ³⁹, makes the double sequence of history sweep to these culminating tribulations without a break. But in the *second* assignation of concords, the sequence is broken by the Sabbath : Gog appears after the bliss of the third *status* and this may be linked with the first sequence to which we referred in the *Liber Concordie* ⁴⁰, in which the Greek persecution under Antiochus Epiphanes follows the Sabbath and is carefully distinguished from those of the seven seals which precede it. This figure in the *Liber Figurarum* clearly embodies the first assignation of concords, the pattern of twos : it gives the double sequence of sevens sweeping right to the end of time with no dual sixth tribulation and no intervening Sabbath. In introducing Gog it emphasises one point clearly, for this crisis is quite consistently placed by Joachim at the very end of history, immediately before the Second Advent ⁴¹. History, then, ends with tribulation. This crisis of Gog, in Joachim's developed Trinitarian scheme is, however, never identified with the culminating persecution of the Church, the *Antichristus ultimus et pessimus*, or seventh head of the Dragon. That must precede the Sabbath Age of the third *status*, but at its close must come the armies of Gog, the final flick, as it were, of the Dragon's tail, where, indeed, Gog appears in the Dragon figure ⁴². Thus, whereas in Joachim's fully developed scheme, Antichrist must come at the

38. Pl. VIII.

39. See above, p. 212-214.

40. See above, p. 215.

41. See, for example, *Expos.*, f. 212^r : *Igitur post ruinam septimi capitis erit pax et post pacem persecutio designata in cauda*. Also f. 10^v-11^r, 24^v, 112^r-114^r.

42. Pl. XIV. See also *De vita sancti Benedicti*, p. 67 : ... *Gog, per quem draco rufus, ac si verberare caude, ... persequetur electos*.

close of the *sixth* age, *before* the Sabbath, Gog and Magog must come at the close of the *seventh*, *after* the Sabbath and immediately preceding the Second Advent, as its Old Testament equivalent did the First. Thus we see both an aspect of pessimism, deriving from the pattern of twos, and an aspect of optimism, deriving from the pattern of threes, in Joachim's view of history. It is the former that has been missed by many students of Joachimism, both ancient and modern, who have thought it an essential part of the abbot's philosophy of history that there should be no declension from the peace and beatitude of the third *status* before the end of time, and have believed or attacked him accordingly. The pessimistic aspect finds a not very prominent place in Joachim's chief writings ⁴³. In the *Liber Figurarum* it is stated here in a pattern of twos and, more clearly, within the framework of threes, in the figures of the Tree-Ladders ⁴⁴. The clearest synthesis, however, of the elements of pessimism and optimism will be found, as we shall see, in the tract *De Septem Sigillis*.

The companion figure to the Concord of Persecutions is a Concord of Persons in the Old and New Dispensations, arranged thus ⁴⁵:

Adam	Concordia Prima	Ozias
Noe	Concordia Secunda	Zorobabel
Jacob	Concordia Tertia	Christus
David	Concordia Quarta	Silvester Papa
Ezechias	Concordia Quinta	Zacharias Papa
Percussio Prime Babylo-		
nis	Concordia Sexta	Percussio Babylonis
		nove
Johannes Baptista	Concordia Septima	Helias Propheta

This should be linked with another pair of figures, that of the Babylon-Rome trees or standards, in which the successive stages of history are arranged thus ⁴⁶:

David 4 th Jerusalem			Silvester Papa 4 th Ecclesia		
3 rd Syrians and Philistines	} {	Syrians and Philistines	5 th 3 rd Pagani	Gothi	5 th
2 nd Egyptians		Egyptians	6 th 2 nd Judei	Galli	6 th
1 st Ur of Chaldees		Chaldaeans	7 th 1 st Babylonenses	Alamani	7 th
Locus		Babylon	Locus	Roma	Locus

Here we have another example of the way in which the *Liber Figurarum* picks up and develops ideas buried like seeds in the two main

43. See reference in note 41 above and also *Lib. Conc.*, f. 56^{r-v}.

44. Pl. XX, XXI.

45. Pl. VII.

46. Pl. XVI, XVII.

works. The best clue to both these figures lies in a passage at the end of the *Liber Concordie* ⁴⁷. Here Joachim is struck by the concord between the vision of Daniel (in the sixth seal of the Old Testament) of a 'man clothed in linen which was upon the waters of the rivers' ⁴⁸ and the Angel of the Sixth Opening in the Apocalypse ⁴⁹. This brings to mind once more the two basic principles on which he had constructed his scheme of history in the earlier part of the book: the Seven Seals and the reckoning of generations in groups of 21 and 42. Then there forms in his mind a new pattern of double sevens: concords of persons in which the second of each pair is 42 generations after the first:

Adam	42 generations	Ozias
Shem	42 generations	Salathiel
Jacob	42 generations	Christ
David	42 generations	Constantine
Ozias	42 generations	Erastetius
Sedechias	}	42 generations
Fall of Babylon		
Seventh not given.		present time

It will be observed at once that the Concords of Persons in the *Liber Figurarum* follows this pattern and completes it ⁵⁰. But the mention of Babylon started the formation of a new pattern in the mind of Joachim. In the days of Adam, Cain was born, the true founder of the first Babylon; in the days of Ozias, Rea Sylvia gave birth to Romulus who, killing his twin Remus, became the founder of the second Babylon. In contrast, Sarah and Rebecca signify the first Jerusalem, which finds its parallel in the foundation of the Papacy, the second Jerusalem, while the glorification of Jerusalem under David concords with the glorification of the Papacy in the person of Pope Sylvester under Constantine. Thus the idea of the two Babylons and the two Jerusalems arises out of the system of numerical calculations and concords in the *Liber Concordie*.

It naturally plays a large part in the *Expositio*, where the fall of

47. *Lib. Conc.*, f. 133^v-134^v.
48. *Daniel*, 10, 5; 12, 6.7.
49. *Apoc.* 10, 1-6.
50. The name variations are of little import: Salathiel is interchangeable with Zorobabel (his son); Constantine and Silvester represent the same period in the Church's history and David can be paralleled with both (see references in note 18 above); Ozias (Uzziah) and Ezechias (Hezekiah), with only two generations between them, bear much the same significance for Joachim; Pope Zacharias (741-752) does not, however, correspond so closely with 'Erastetius', a misreading for Heraclius (Emperor, 610-641).

the two Babylons is placed in the Sixth Seal and associated with the great crisis of Antichrist preceding the Seventh Seal. But it is only in the Babylon-Rome figures of the *Liber Figurarum* that the idea takes a new and significant shape. The persecutions of the seals and the concords of generations find an echo here but the whole conception of history as a rising scale of tribulation to the Sixth Seal, followed by the triumph of the seventh, is lost ; instead, the motion of history is one of rise and fall in a circular movement which almost suggests the wheel of fortune⁵¹. The Chosen People issues forth from Babylon, journeys upwards through the 'loci' of various struggles to a place of glory and then descends again to bondage in Babylon. The pattern is so new that, were it not for the close links which, as we have shown, bind it to the writings, one would be tempted at first sight to regard it as a later addition. But further reflection suggests that it is completely in character, if somewhat enigmatic in intention. It serves to emphasise both the way in which Joachim played on variations of his themes and the point which we have already made, that, although his view of history may be termed in general 'optimistic' he did not exclude the note of tribulation and pessimism from the final stages.

We may, perhaps, find Joachim's play upon the theme of sevens best summed up in two figures of the Seven *Etates*⁵². These bear the same relation to each other as the two pairs of Tables of Concords in that the first gives the double sweep of history alone while the second combines this with the pattern of threes. The second, in fact, combines nearly all Joachim's number symbolisms since it works into one design the double pattern of sevens (expressed in two sequences of seven *secula* or *tempora*), the three *status*, and an over-all sequence of seven *etates*, from Adam to the *Presens Tempus*, which derives from S. Augustine's scheme of history. It also works in the series of great men who serve as milestones in counting the generations and notes the *Inicium Romanorum* under Ozias. Finally, there is a further clarification of Last Things in that the *Tercius Status* and *Clarificatio Spiritus* are clearly placed in the *Etas Septima* while beyond, specifically marked off from this, is the *Etas Octava* and the *Resurrectio Mortuorum*. This distinction between the Sabbath of History or Third *Status* and the Eighth Day of Eternity beyond the grave is an important one in Joachim's scheme of history but rarely in the writings is it stated so clearly⁵³.

51. In MS. *Dresden A. 121*, f. 94^v, these figures are drawn in an almost circular form.

52. Pl. XVIII a, b.

53. See *Lib. Conc.*, f. 132^v ; *Expos.*, f. 212^r. See also *De vita sancti Benedicti*, p. 50, for an unusual description of the Sabbath of Eternity as the *quartus status*.

Summing up this brief discussion of the Seven Seals and Persecutions in these three works, we would emphasise the following points : first, that the double pattern of sevens is a basic concept in Joachim's thought about history, characteristic equally of all three works ; secondly, that when the persecutions are set out there is a noticeable absence of variation in the first five Seals and Openings and that the variations in the Sixth and Seventh arise from the problem of fitting in the concept of the third *status* ; thirdly, that the *Liber Figurarum* serves both to 'fix' the main designs and to complete them in a way which suggests that here we have a final clarification of thought and imagination on these matters.

DE SEPTEM SIGILLIS.

We have followed the tradition of the Renaissance bibliographers in naming the small tract, which we have now identified in six manuscripts, the *De Septem Sigillis*⁵⁴. The argument for its authenticity⁵⁵ rests on three points : the strength of the manuscript evidence, dealt with below⁵⁶ ; the absence of obviously spurious elements in the text ; the closeness of its relation to the two main works and the *Liber Figurarum*. It is with the last of these that we must now deal. An examination of the text shows at once that its general scheme is based upon the key passages in the *Liber Concordie* and the *Expositio* which we have already examined. But its connections are closer than this. Joachim's parallels and concords are scattered through the two works in innumerable passages. Here many of them are brought together and set down in an ordered form which not only embodies the two basic concepts of seals and parallel generations, but gathers up so many of the elaborations on these themes. This point can best be made by means of a table setting out in detail the content of the *De Septem Sigillis* with corresponding references to the two main works and the *Liber Figurarum* :

54. TRITHEMIUS, *Liber de scriptoribus ecclesiasticis*, Basle, 1494, *sub. nom.* He is followed by C. GESNER, *Bibliotheca universalis*, Zurich, 1545, *sub. nom.* ; A. WION, *Lignum vitae*, Venice, 1595, II, 792 ; C. HENRIQUEZ, *Fasc. S. Ord. Cisterc.*, Brussels, 1623, f. 735-740.

55. Previously this text had been known only from one MS., *Vat. Lat. 3822*. O. HOLDER-EGGER, in *Neues Archiv* 33 (1908) p. 98, thought it « natürlich pseudo-joachitisch ». J. BIGNAMI-ODIER, *loc. cit.*, p. 223, judged it to be « après Joachim de Flore ».

56. See below, p. 231 ff.

Relations between the 'De Septem Sigillis' and the 'Liber Concordie' (C), the 'Expositio in Apocalypsim' (E) and the 'Liber Figurarum' (F).

<i>First Seal</i> ⁵⁷	<i>First Opening</i>	C, 4 ^v , 7 ^v , 12 ^r , 18 ^r , 22 ^v -23 ^r , 26 ^r , 31 ^v , 38 ^v -39 ^v , 57 ^r , 86 ^r - 89 ^v , 113 ^r . E, 4 ^r , 6 ^v -7 ^r , 9 ^v , 16 ^v -17 ^v , 20 ^v , 28 ^r - 29 ^v , 62 ^r , 103 ^r , 114 ^r , 147 ^v . F, Pl. III, IV, IX, X, VIII, XIV, XVIIIa, b, I, II, V, VI.
Abraham, Isaac, Jacob	Zacharias, John Baptist, Christ	
Sojourn in Egypt	Nativity	
Exodus	Passion (and Resurrection) ⁵⁸	
Persecution of Pharaoh and Crossing of Red Sea	Twelve Apostles	
Giving of the Law	Seventy-Two Disciples	
Moses and Aaron	Exodus from Synagogue	
Twelve Princes of People	Coming of Holy Ghost	
Seventy-Two Seniores	Paul and Barnabas	
Inheritance of 5 + 7 Tribes	Inheritance of 5 + 7 Churches	
<i>Second Seal</i>	<i>Second Opening</i>	C, 4 ^v -5 ^v , 26 ^r -v, 39 ^r . E, 4 ^r , 6 ^v -7 ^r , 9 ^v , 114 ^r , 128 ^v . F, Pl. III, IV, IX, X, VIII, XIV, XVIII a, b.
Conflict with Canaanites etc. Joshua to David	Conflict of Martyrs with Pagans	
<i>Third Seal</i>	<i>Third Opening</i>	C, 5 ^r , 17 ^v , 22 ^v , 26 ^r -v, 39 ^v -40 ^v , 46 ^r -48 ^v , 125 ^r . E, 4 ^r , 6 ^v -7 ^r , 9 ^v , 62 ^r , 114 ^v , 128 ^v , 142 ^r - 143 ^r , 162 ^r -163 ^v . F, Pl. III, IV, IX, X, VIII, XIV, XVIII a, b.
Conflict with Syrians, Philistines etc.	Conflict of Doctors with Arians, Goths, Vandals, Lombards and Persians	
Schism of Judah and Israel	Schism of Latin and Greek Churches	
<i>Fourth Seal</i>	<i>Fourth Opening</i>	C, 9 ^r , 23 ^r , 26 ^r -v, 32 ^v -36 ^v , 40 ^r -41 ^r , 66 ^v -68 ^v , 122 ^v . E, 4 ^r , 6 ^v -7 ^r , 9 ^v , 115 ^v -116 ^r , 129 ^v , 143 ^r , 162 ^r -163 ^v . F, Pl. III, IV, IX, X, VIII, XIV, XVIII a, b.
Elijah, Elisha and Sons of Prophets	Virgins and Hermits	
Conflict with Assyrians	Conflict with Saracens	

57. In the First Seal all the concords of the openings do not directly match. On the problem of the order of the phrases in this seal, see below, p. 235.

58. Although the Resurrection is required in concordance with the Crossing of the Red Sea, it is only mentioned incidentally towards the end of the Opening.

<i>Fifth Seal</i>	<i>Fifth Opening</i>	C, 4^r-5^r, 26^r, 36^v, 41^r, 49^r-50^r, 122^v, 134^v. E, 4^r, 6^v-7^v, 9^v, 116^r, 130^v-133^r. F, Pl. III, IV, IX, X, VIII, XVIII a, b.
Ten Tribes taken into Captivity, Judah confirmed	Latin Church confirmed	
Prophets of God arise	Spiritual Men arise typified in 5 th part of Apoc.	
Conflict with King of Babylon	Conflict with Princes of World, esp. Teutons	
<i>Sixth Seal</i>	<i>Sixth Opening</i>	C, 4^v-5^r, 26^r, 37^v- 38^r, 41^v, 134^v. E, 4^r, 6^v-9^r, 41^v, 117^v, 198^r-204^v, 207^r-209^v. F, Pl. III, IV, IX, X, VII, VIII.
Transmigratio Jerusalem	Transmigratio spiritualis Jerusalem	
Fall of Old Babylon	Fall of New Babylon	
Double Conflict of Israel	Double Conflict with Two Kings	
(Books of Judith and Esther) Jerusalem rebuilt	Sancta Civitas rebuilt Devil incarcerated	
<i>Seventh Seal</i>	<i>Seventh Opening</i>	C, 4^v-5^r, 26^r, 38^r, 41^v. E, 9^v, 123^r, 214^v- 215^v. F, Pl. III, IV, I, XVIIIb, XIX.
Cessation of History and Prophecy	Labour of Exposition of Scriptures ceases	
Sabbath until Antiochus Epiphanes appears	Sabbath until Devil released and Gog appears	
First Advent of Christ	Second Advent of Christ	
Passion and Resurrection	Last Tribulation	E, 24^v. F, Pl. XVIIIb, XIX.
Coming of Holy Ghost	Resurrection of Dead	
	Eternal Bliss	

Once again, we note, the persecutions follow the usual pattern, including the reference to the German crisis, but Joachim also works in a number of other historical parallels which from the writings we see to have been of particular significance to him. That the first seal and opening yield the most fruits in this respect links it closely with the *Liber Concordie*, as do the emphasis given to the Schism of Judah and Israel, Elijah, Elisha and the Sons of the Prophets, the Captivity and the Prophets, the Books of Judith and Esther and the Return, with the New Testament concords of all these. Two details of the first seal may be picked out as especially demonstrating the closeness of relationship between the two works. It will be observed that the parallel groups of Elders and Disciples are given as 72 instead of the 70 recorded in Scripture⁵⁹: the clue to this lies in a passage of the *Liber Concordie* in which Joachim explains how he arrives at the number 72⁶⁰. Immediately following is a curious statement on the

59. See *Numbers* 11, 16.24; *Luke*, 10, 1.

60. *Lib. Conc.*, f. 12^r. See also *Expos.*, f. 220^r.

inheritance of 12 Tribes and Churches, 5 first and 7 afterwards. This carries a symbolic meaning of peculiar importance for Joachim⁶¹ which finds striking expression in the *Liber Figurarum*, but we also find three passages in the *Liber Concordie* in which this distinctive point is made in conjunction with several others also picked out for emphasis under this first seal⁶². The relation of the tract to the *Expositio* is demonstrated even more obviously by the linking of each Opening with a corresponding part of the Apocalypse⁶³. Furthermore, the first four persecutions of the Openings are associated with the pattern of four orders which we have seen to be characteristic of the *Expositio*⁶⁴.

In all manuscripts but one the *De Septem Sigillis* is found associated with the *Liber Figurarum* or figures from it⁶⁵. We have already seen that a number of these figures are built on the same two basic principles as the *De Septem Sigillis*. In fact all the historical figures bear a general relation to it, and many of the details correspond as well, as appears in the table above. One or two of these details are especially significant. As already pointed out, the distinctive detail of the division of the inheritance of the 12 into 5 and 7 is strikingly embodied in the figures of the grand Tree-Eagles⁶⁶, to the understanding of which our little tract would thus contribute. Under the Sixth and Seventh Seals and Openings, we notice, the arrangement corresponds to the later rather than the earlier Tables of Concords⁶⁷ and the Sabbath Age is clearly emphasised. The most interesting point, however, is that the tract goes on to another, post-Seventh Seal section in which there is both a final tribulation, — of Antiochus Epiphanes and Gog-Magog respectively, — and a final bliss of an eighth day which is beyond history and therefore beyond anything known in the seventh age. Both these ideas, as we have seen, can be tracked down in the two main works; they find clearer expression in the *Liber Figurarum*; it is, however, in the *De Septem Sigillis* that Joachim states them quite unequivocally and precisely.

Clarification seems to be the main function of Joachim's figures. His writings are like musical compositions in which the main themes recur with varying elaborations. Sometimes in the treatment of one

61. This is one of Joachim's most distinctive interpretations. For the key-passages expounding it in the works, see table above. For a brief explanation, see M. REEVES, in *Mediaeval and Renaissance Studies* 2 (1950) p. 77-79.

62. *Lib. Conc.*, f. 31^v, 39^r, 57^{r-v}.

63. See text below.

64. See above p. 219.

65. See description of manuscripts below, p. 231-233.

66. Pl. V, VI.

67. See above, p. 221.

theme there is an echo of another ; frequently the ornamentation of the theme varies. In the figures Joachim's main themes receive a statement which is clear and definite. Thus the *De Septem Sigillis* is seen to serve the function of a figure in that it states, with detail selected from many passages, one basic theme in the clearest possible form. The most appropriate form of figure for this theme is that of parallel columns in which the seals and their openings are strictly matched. This is done with considerable care in two of the best manuscripts⁶⁸ and, though the arrangement is lost in others, the tract was probably intended as a diagram or scheme of history rather than a literary composition. This view is supported by the words within the text itself : ' in hac carta ' ⁶⁹. It seems, therefore, to be the simplest type of figure. Was it one of the Abbot's first attempts to express himself schematically in order to meet the growing demand for a clear, popular guide to the meaning of history ? Is it an embryo figure from which some of the elaborate designs of the *Liber Figurarum* grew ? It is difficult to say with confidence that it is earlier than the *Liber Figurarum*, unless we argue that simplicity must inevitably precede elaboration. One other consideration might suggest that it should be placed earlier : it is built entirely on the pattern of twos. True, it points to the pattern of threes in the 5 / 7 division of the 12 tribes and churches ⁷⁰ and the concept of the Sabbath Age is clearly stated, but the threefold division of history is nowhere developed. Thus it covers, in simpler form, only the ground of the historical figures in the *Liber Figurarum*. But the exciting feature of this latter work is the way in which the hints of the Trinitarian pattern of history which occur in the historical figures bud and blossom, like the trees in the figures themselves, into the increasingly mystical figures which embody the pattern of threes and carry one to the real heights of Joachim's poetical imagination. The *De Septem Sigillis* is far more limited and pedestrian, but it does contain his pattern of twos worked out to its fullest extent and, — most important to contemporaries, — with the sequence of Last Things stated as clearly as Joachim would ever venture, right down to Gog and Magog and the Second Advent. The treatment of the Sixth and Seventh Seals and Openings seems to represent Joachim's final thought on a subject which he had declared to be most difficult and most crucial. We do not, therefore, judge this to be an early work, but rather a late one, put together, perhaps, in the same period as the *Liber Figurarum*, in which he sets out to give to a gene-

68. See below, p. 231.

69. See below under the Fifth Opening, p. 243.

70. The way in which the 5 / 7 division symbolises the three *status* is explained in the article referred to above, p. 229, n. 61.

ration standing at the crucial moment of all time the view of history in its sweep towards final climax for which they were so eager and receptive. And since it is of the essence of Joachim's mysticism that it is grounded in the study of history, we — like his contemporaries — must turn first, for the understanding of his thought, to this double procession of peoples, with their tribulations and their triumphs, which seems to march so continuously down the avenues of his mind.

M. REEVES.

The Manuscripts of *De Septem Sigillis*.

The text *De Septem Sigillis* occurs in all manuscripts in which the whole collection of Joachim's *Liber Figurarum* or parts of it are to be found with the exception of the Reggio MS and *Cod. Vat. Lat. 4860*. It is further included in the large collection of Joachim's genuine writings (apart from the *Concordia* and the *Expositio*) in MS *Padua Antoniana 322* which does not contain any figures or texts from the *Liber Figurarum*. The description of most of the MSS can be limited to the chief points, as a fuller description has been given in the Introduction to the 2nd edition of vol. II of the *Liber Figurarum*⁷¹. Thus only the last pages of the Padua MS and the 2nd Paris MS in which the text was recently discovered by M. Reeves, after this Introduction had gone into print, will receive fuller treatment.

O *Oxford, Corpus Christi College 255 A*⁷².

Vellum, 17 fols. The Joachim section is of the early XIIIth cent., probably south-Italian.

Fols. 1^r-3^v: *Homilia Petri Diaconi*, Xth cent.

Fol. 4^v (6^v): JOACHIM OF FIORE, *De Septem Sigillis*.

Fols. 5^r-17^v: JOACHIM OF FIORE, *Liber Figurarum*, 24 full page illuminations.

N *Padua, Biblioteca Antoniana 322*.

Vellum, 380 by 280 mm, fols. 166, first half of the XIIIth cent., containing 16 genuine writings by Joachim of Fiore. This well known Joachim MS has been described in detail⁷³, some anomalies of the very last pages were

71. L. TONDELLI, M. REEVES, B. HIRSCH-REICH, *Il Libro delle figure dell' abate Gioachino da Fiore*, 2nd ed., vol. II, Torino, 1954, p. 15-17.

72. *Ibid.*, p. 15 f., 18-20.

73. Short note by H. DENIFLE, in *Archiv f. Literatur- u. Kirchengesch. d. Mittelalt.* 1 (1885) p. 95 f.; description in greater detail: E. BUONAIUTI, *Edition*

cleared up by Buonaiuti⁷⁴; according to Tondelli⁷⁵ the last fols. were added and have a different size. But it is much more important that they are written in the same hand. The last fol. 166 contains:

Fol. 166^r: JOACHIM OF FIORE, The hymn *De patria celesti*. In the margin, written in the same hand, but in half the size, his 2nd hymn: *Visio de gloria paradisi*, latter part.

Fol. 166^{r-v}: JOACHIM, *De Septem Sigillis*⁷⁶, written in two columns but not corresponding ones, beginning below the 2 hymns. The initials are finely adorned.

Fol. 166^d: At the very bottom of the column the beginning of the *Epistola: Universis Christi fidelibus* (6 lines breaking off with *impius in impietate sua morietur*).

D *Dresden, Sächsische Landesbibliothek A 121.*

Vellum, late XIIIth century (or XIVth cent.), containing a collection of Joachim's main works, the *Liber Figurarum* and some more or less important minor writings. This typical Joachite MS includes one spurious work, the *Super Hieremiam*.

Fols. 87^r-96^v: JOACHIM OF FIORE, *Liber Figurarum*.

Fols. 176^r-221^r: JOACHIM, *Tractatus in Evangelia IV*.

Fols. 221^v-222^v: JOACHIM, *De Septem Sigillis* (same hand).

Fols. 223^r-225^r: JOACHIM, *Contra Judeos*.

(Cf. F. SCHNORR VON CAROLSFELD, *Katalog der Hss. der k. Bibl. Dresden*, I, 1882, p. 57).

P² *Paris, Bibliothèque nationale, Cod. Lat. 11864 (St. Germain 58)⁷⁷.*

Vellum, 415 by 280 mm, 152 fols. XIIth, XIIIth cent. Provenance: the abbey of St. Peter and St. Paul, Corbie, Somme, from which it came to St. Germain-des-Prés.

Fols. 1-151^r: ISIDORE OF SEVILLE, *Epistola ad Braulionem Episc.* and *Liber XX Etymolog.*, XIIth cent., c. 1180.

of the *Tractatus super IV Evangelia*, Rome, 1930, p. LXVIII; a full analysis of the contents by J. CHR. HUCK, *Joachim von Floris und die joachitische Literatur*, Freiburg i. Br., 1938, p. 158-182; he arrives at 12 Joachitist writings only, because following the catalogues by MANCIOTTI and IOSA he assumes that *De articulis fidei* which lacks an *Explicit* ends on fol. 166^v instead of fol. 162^a, and therefore takes the two hymns (ed. Venet. 1725 after the *Psalterium*, fol. 279^r f., 280^r f.) to be the conclusion of this tract and *Universis Christi fidelibus* with Joachim's name as evidence for the author.

74. Edition of the *De articulis fidei*, Rome, 1936, p. LXXX.

75. *Il Libro delle Figure*, I, p. 229; I², p. 264. TONDELLI therefore concludes that the hymns were not covered by the authenticity of the whole MS; but the hymns, *De Septem Sigillis* and the first lines of the *Epistola... Universis Christi fidelibus* are written in the same hand as *De articulis fidei* (facsimile page in BUONAIUTI's edition, tav. I, facing p. 80). Thus the evidence for their genuine character is greatly strengthened; see also H. GRUNDMANN, *Neue Forschungen über Joachim von Fiore*, Marburg, 1950, p. 29.

76. Strangely enough this text has been overlooked by all, until M. Reeves identified it.

77. Cf. M. REEVES, B. HIRSCH-REICH, in *Mediaeval and Renaissance Studies* 3 (1954) p. 198.

- Fol. 151^v: JOACHIM, *Earlier Tables of Concorde, Liber Figurarum*.
 Fol. 152^r: JOACHIM, *De Septem Sigillis*.
 Fols. 151^v-152^c: PSEUDO-JOACHIM, *Epistola subsequentium figurarum*.
 Fol. 152^{c-d}: JOACHIM, *Epistola... Universis Christi fidelibus*.

The Joachim section of 3 pages at the end of the MS is written throughout in the same small, careful hand of the 1st half of the XIIIth cent. The large size of the MS has enabled the scribe to place the Old and New Testament tables side by side. They are carefully executed and well coordinated. Also the Old and New Testament columns of *De Septem Sigillis* are carefully set out in corresponding columns (two each). The *Epistola subseq. figurarum*, however, is written across the bottom of fols. 151^r and 152^r in two columns, and is continued on fol. 152^v, col. 1. It is worth noting that the section: *Prima pars Apoc.* etc., which in the two other MSS V²P occurs at the end (cf. TONDELLI's edition in vol. I, p. 44; I², p. 43), appears here as inserted into the space at the foot of the first two corresponding columns of *De Septem Sigillis* and above another part of the so-called *Epistola* in the same hand, but twice as large.

V² *Vat. Lat. 3822.*

Vellum; I-112 fols., XIIIth-XIVth cent., probably south-Italian; misc. MS containing genuine and spurious writings of Joachim of Fiore, prophecies etc. Detailed description by J. BIGNAMI-ODIER, in *Mélanges d'archéologie et d'histoire* 54 (1937) p. 214ff., 219ff.

Fols. 1^a-1^c: JOACHIM, *Epistola... Universis Christi fidelibus*.

Fols. 1^c-2^b: JOACHIM, *Septem tempora Veteris et Novi Testamenti (De Septem Sigillis)*.

Fols. 2^v-3^r: JOACHIM, *Earlier Tables of Concorde, Liber Figurarum*.

Fols. 3^c-4^a: PS.-JOACHIM, *Epistola subsequentium figurarum*.

P *Paris, Bibliothèque nationale, Cod. Lat. 3595.*

Paper, I-63 fols., XIVth cent., South France or Italy; misc. MS containing genuine and spurious writings of Joachim of Fiore etc.

Fol. 19^v: *Verba et signa et notabilia que vidit et narravit Joachim*.

Fols. 19^v-21^v: JOACHIM, *Epistola... Universis Christi fidelibus*.

Fols. 22^r-25^v: JOACHIM, *Earlier Tables of Concorde, Liber Figurarum*.

Fols. 25^v-28^r: JOACHIM, *De Septem Sigillis*.

Fols. 28^r-29^r: PS.-JOACHIM, *Epistola subsequentium figurarum*.

As the description of the MSS shows, our text appears with different preceding and/or following writings in the exclusively Joachimist MSS O N D ⁷⁸. In the earliest MS from Oxford its place before the *Liber Figurarum* seems to be the most appropriate one. In P² where 4 short Joachimist texts are added on the *verso* of the conclusion of Isidore's *Etymologie* and the last fol. of the MS, and in the two miscellaneous MSS V² and P with three more Joachim texts (one of them spurious), *De Septem Sigillis* occurs in a fixed set.

⁷⁸ D contains one spurious work: *Super Hieremiam*.

THE CHARACTERISTICS
OF THE INDIVIDUAL MANUSCRIPTS : THEIR RELATIONS.

As to the peculiarities of the MSS and their relations the results obtained regarding the *Liber Figurarum*, are here confirmed. In addition the recent discovery of our little tract in N and P² has provided some further clues, while its omission in the Reggio MS (R) of the *Liber Figurarum* which is nearly wholly dependent on O⁷⁹, is of no avail.

Two criteria reveal something of the relations of the MSS and their value : a) the arrangement of the texts ; b) the headings of the individual paragraphs. But the correct arrangement is not of such importance as in the *Liber Figurarum*. Only in O D P² is the coordination of the 7 seals and their resp. openings side by side, in double columns correct. As the texts of the openings are usually longer, the scribe of O who was — quite unnecessarily — anxious to save space in order to get his text on one page, allowed the last parts of some openings to overflow into the blank space below the resp. seals, dividing them carefully off by clear lines. The deterioration starts in N where each seal is followed by its resp. opening in the same column ; the copyist seems to have copied his source by reading across the two corresponding columns. In V² and P, however, all 7 seals are given first, and then their openings follow afterwards, even worse, the 7th opening and the conclusion are written out directly after the corresponding O T parts which suggests that in their common source these parts were placed on the succeeding page and so were later copied together, until the scribe remembered to copy the first page of his text. The short text has no title ; in V², however, a XIVth century hand added in the top margin on fol. 1^a : *VII tempora veteris testamenti* and equally on fol. 2^a : *VII tempora novi testamenti*. 'Tempus' seems to have been adopted from the headings. Apart from N P all paragraphs with the exception of the two concluding passages are marked out by headings ; in O and D P² they give the numbers of the seals and their resp. openings, though with slight variants ; in V², on the other hand, *tempus* is used invariably for both with occasional additions. D alone has no initials in larger size.

- O In MS O our text is written on the *verso* of what is today the « fly leaf » of the *Liber Figurarum*⁸⁰. The writing is very similar to its texts,

79. Cf. 2nd ed. of the *Libro delle Figure*, II, p. 24 f.

80. Cf. *Introductio* to vol. II², p. 19, col. 1.

but the letters seem to be narrower ; more and also some other abbreviations are used, e. g. the hook for *et* also for endings in *licet*, *influet* etc. But the narrower hand writing may be due to the apprehension of the scribe to find enough space for the two double columns on one page. It is worth noting that *De Septem Sigillis* is not mentioned in the XVth cent. list of contents⁸¹. The *cronice* which appear in it between the three main works of Joachim (without his name) and *arbores cum sigillis* (i. e. the *Liber Figurarum*) should cover 4 fols. and therefore cannot be identical with our text. As the earliest MS, O has the best text and is nearest to the archetype, as in the case of the *Liber Figurarum*. Here again it is the only MS free from misreadings and bad spelling mistakes. The text was revised, but it is clear from one instance (*re*- added on top of *edificati*, *Sigillum* VI, 13-14) that none of the sources of the other MSS were used, as they all have *edificati*). In a few instances O has the only correct readings ; both conspicuous and minor deviations in the other MSS turn out to be deliberate alterations, sometimes apparently in order to achieve a more homogeneous text. As in the texts of the *Liber Figurarum* O has some *lapsus pennae*, the most notable being *Arriani* instead of *Arriana* (*Apertio* III, 15) ; there are also some small omissions (e. g. *Sigillum* I, 8). There is one striking fact : in all MSS apart from P² the successive Old Testament events in *Sigillum* I are given in a wrong order, i. e. *de exitu filiorum Israel de Egipto* is placed after the giving of the Law on Sinai instead of after *de mora... in Egipto* ; in addition the words *De Moyse et Aaron* preceding the phrase in P² are omitted. Apparently owing to the *homoioteleuta* : *in Egipto... de Egipto*, the words *de exitu* etc. had been omitted in the early common source of all MSS (apart from P²) perhaps as early as the archetype, and was added in the margin with or without a mark ; but all copyists inserted the words *de exitu* etc. in the wrong place. This mistake is an *error significativus*⁸², because it is highly improbable that all copyists should have given exactly the same confused order of well known biblical events independently. It is worth noting that the man who revised the text of O or any other copyists failed to notice the mistake, apart from the scribe of P² himself or of its source.

N The next best copy after O is provided by N which belongs also to the 1st half of the XIIIth century. Its recent discovery is important, because it confirms readings of O to which it is closely related. Only ON give correctly (*synagoga*) *Judeorum* against *satane* in all other

81. Cf. M. REEVES, in *Mediaeval and Renaissance Studies* 2 (1950) p. 58, n. 1 ; *Libro delle Figure*, Introd. to vol. II², p. 19, col. 2.

82. Cf. the terminology in P. MAAS, *Textkritik*, 2nd ed., Leipzig, 1950, p. 27.

MSS, in *Apertio* I, 7; also, N shares the few mistakes of O: *Arriani* instead of *Arriana* (see above) and the few omissions. N has also some readings and some mistakes in common with D, e. g. *ystorie* (also with P²) against *historia* (O) in *Sigillum* VII, 13, but mostly they are too insignificant to provide a clue to their mutual relations, while the dependence on O is beyond doubt, though it seems to be indirectly. Finally N has also some insignificant readings in common with P² and/or V²P, in addition to D, e. g. in *Apertio* VI, 18-19 (against O P²). Like P it omits all headings. It has some readings peculiar to itself and some spelling mistakes. No other MS is dependent on N.

- D** As to MS D although the figures and texts in the *Liber Figurarum* go back to a MS earlier than O⁸³, there are not enough clues to fix its precise relations to the other MSS; it is independent of all of them. Also Buonaiuti established in his edition of the *Tractatus super IV Evangelia*⁸⁴ full independence of D and N. The same results hold good for *De Septem Sigillis*. D has some insignificant readings and mistakes in common with O (and N), e. g. in *Apertio* II, 3-4, also in *Apertio* III, 17, and V, 19. In *Apertio* I, 3-4 it shares the correct reading of O N against the 'improved' wording of P²V²P. A closer link to P² can be established by their identical headings which slightly deviate from those of O. As to the relation of the MS D to the group V²P, they have one notable deliberate alteration in common: (*synagoga*) *satane*⁸⁵ for *Judeorum* (O N), while here P² omits the relevant word (*Apertio* I, 7); D agrees with the whole group or V²P only in many minor matters, e. g. *Sigillum* II, 6 plural with V²P against the singular in O N P²; D P²V²P om. *doctorum* in *Apertio* III, 13-14; again plural with V²P against the singular in *Apertio* V, 6. But all of these are too insignificant to draw confidently conclusions from them. D has a comparatively good text on the whole. As to readings peculiar to itself, D has many small omissions, and as in the *Liber Figurarum* some very bad misreadings, e. g. *Apertio* I *scilicet* for *spiritus sanctus*; *Apertio* II *ñrum* for *mrum* (*martyrum*); *Sigillum* V *nunc die* for *iracundie*; *Apertio* VI, 1 (*ecclesia*) *clericorum*⁸⁶ for *electorum*. As in the *Liber Figurarum* the copyist of D inserts (in one instance only) *h'es* into Biblical names: *Azahehelis* for *Azael* in *Sigillum* IV.

- P²** MS P² forms a group with V² P. All three MSS contain the same set

83. Cf. *Libro delle Figure*, II², p. 22b.

84. *Ibid.*, p. LXIX; see also E. FRANCESCHINI, in *Aevum* 9 (1925) p. 481 ff.

85. Cf. *Apertio* VI where *synagoga satane* means the Christians who are none.

86. This is rather a strange slip for a Joachite scribe, because it is identified with the Holy City.

of 4 texts of Joachim (one spurious one) : *De Septem Sigillis*, the Earlier Tables of Concords from the *Liber Figurarum*, the *Epistola subsequentium figurarum*, the *Epistola... Joachim... Universis Christi fidelibus*, though in a different order. As V² P have three more genuine and spurious texts resp., we may assume that the scribe of P² selected from a small collection, what he wished to write out on these last three pages of an Isidore MS, though we cannot assert that the 'Single Tree' from the *Liber Figurarum* in its pseudo-Joachimist version⁸⁷ (peculiar to V²P only) was included in it. As P² has not been dealt with before, we may point out here that the close relation of P² to V²P is evident in all texts they have preserved. In the 'Earlier Tables of Concords' they agree in one striking mistake : Aaron instead of Azarias in the NT Table ; in the so-called *Epistola subsequentium figurarum*⁸⁸ P² lacks with P the addition of *anni a passione* in V² by which the critical date is shifted from 1260 to 1290. P² has also many insignificant readings in common with P against V² ; finally it provides parts of phrases missing in V²P because of *homoioteleuta*. Also as regards our text P² is superior to V² and P. It is worth noting that P² has some insignificant readings in common with O (*Apertio* VI, 18), with ON (*Apertio* III, 12), with OND (*Apertio* V, 19) etc. against V²P ; but they do not carry much weight. On the other hand some of the readings which go back to the common source of the group P²V²P are deliberate alterations. Apart from *Apertio* I, 3-4, where the meaning was confused, there is a tendency to assimilate the wording in the *Apertio* more to that of its corresponding *Sigillum*, e. g. *Apertio* II, 3-4, or to make the meaning stand out more clearly, e. g. in *Apertio* VI, 9 ; strangely enough (*Consummatis*) *historiis* (correct in OND) was altered in to *mysteriis* at the beginning of the concluding OT paragraph ; the whole group adds *Amen* at the end. It has also some insignificant readings in common, e. g. in *Apertio* V, 15 ; and a number of small additions and omissions. P² has further some quite negligible readings in common with P alone. As to readings peculiar to itself in *Apertio* V, 24 *presentis* seems to be deliberately substituted for *precedentis*. Finally P² has some particularly bad mistakes and a number of explanatory additions peculiar to itself, e. g. in *Apertio* III, 8 it has *IIII* for *VII*, in *Apertio* V, 12 *VI* instead of *VII* (*angeli*) ; it excels in the worst spelling mistakes, e. g. in *Sigillum* IV : *Azaeris* for *Azael* ; *Yzatam* for *Isaiam* (in *Sigillum* V, 9 *Yzaya*). Because of these slips the standard of this text is definitely inferior to that of the other texts. The additions are quite frequent and aim at completion. In *Apertio* VII, 6 and 8

87. Cf. *Libro delle Figure*, II², p. 16 f.

88. Ed. J. BIGNAMI-ODIER, *loc. cit.*, p. 224-226 ; TONDELLI, *loc. cit.*, I, p. 42-44 ; I², p. 38-43.

Antichristus is substituted for Gog, but Gog and Magog are added shortly afterwards. It is a striking fact that P² has the appropriate order in three instances against all other MSS : 1) In *Sigillum* I (see above p. 235) it is not possible to state, whether the source of P² gave the events of *Exodus* in the proper succession or whether the copyist corrected the wrong order ; but there is also the notable omission of *persecutione Pharaonis et in Sigillum* I, p. 240, 1-2⁸⁹. 2) In *Apertio* V, 20 the general remark : *Et sciendum est...limitibus suis* is not inserted, where it interrupts the historical events, but is placed at the end and written across both columns, the OT and NT ones. Judged by the standards of P² in most of these Joachimist texts this seem to be a deliberate 'improvement' of Joachim's less tidy arrangement. 3) P² alone has *in diebus Zorobabel... consolationem accepit* in the *Sigillum* VI, against its place in the *Apertio* VI, 3-6. All these peculiarities confirm the fact that V² and P cannot be dependent on P², but that they all can be traced back to a single common source.

V²P V² and P are much more closely connected with each other than with P². The most important mistake they have in common, the wrong arrangement and the misplacement of the 7th *Apertio* and the conclusion, have been dealt with before (p. 234). But as in the *Liber Figurarum*⁹⁰, where similar misplacements occur in V² P, some are corrected by the scribe of V², while the copyist of P completely fails to understand the meaning. One notable slip of both MSS may be mentioned among many insignificant readings, omissions and additions : *persequutio Babylonis* for *percussio* (*percuccio* P²) in *Sig.* VI, 8. It is worth noting that in the *Liber Figurarum* (Pl. VII) D also falls into this error, while O alone gives the appropriate reading ; but in this text D is correct. Once again each MS (V² and P) has mistakes peculiar to itself : V² for instance has *confortatum* for *confirmatum* in *Sig.* V, 5 and in *Sig.* III, p. 242, 3 *conversatio* instead of *concertatio* (P : *con-turbatio*). V² is also once again the only MS containing pseudo-Joachimist additions, though here it is only a reference to 1260 years until the persecution by Antichrist counting from the resurrection (i.e. 1290 years), in *Apertio* I, 20. P has some bad misspellings, not only in proper names, and misreadings and slips, e. g. *in initio* for *initiatio* (correct in all other MSS) ; in *Apertio* VI, 10, where V² omits *nova* before *Babylon*, P alone adds *nova* to *Babylon* further on (variant 12). In further instances P adds some explanations, but on the other hand omits necessary words. All this evidence shows that as in the *Liber*

89. This omission is worth noting, because the persecution is the chief element in all paragraphs.

90. Vol. II², Introduction, p. 28, col. 1.

figurarum V² and P do not depend on each other but have a common source.

In conclusion it may be stated that the discovery of P² throws more light on the relation of the MSS V²P to the other MSS ; but the intermediary position of D between the groups ON and P²V²P cannot be further determined, because of lack of convincing affinities, i. e. notable mistakes in common with the one or other group. Therefore it does not seem advisable to draw a stemma.

In order to relieve the apparatus the following variants have been omitted as a rule : reversal of two or more words, spelling mistakes, obvious insignificant slips, e. g. grammatical ones.

B. HIRSCH-REICH.

The Text : *De Septem Sigillis.*

PRIMUM SIGILLUM.

Sub hoc tempore continetur de Abraham, Ysaac et Jacob et filiis et nepotibus eius ; de mora eorum dem filiorum Israel in Egypto ; de Moyse et Aaron et exitu filiorum

APERTIO EIUSDEM.

Sub hoc tempore continetur specialiter principium evangelii Luce in quo ordine agitur de Zacharia sacerdote et Johanne filio eius a quo baptizatus est Christus ; de

1 Sigillum primum : *this reversed order occurs in all headings D P² ; Tempus for Sigillum in all headings, in the left margin small numbers 1, 2, 3... 8 V² ; after Primum tempus : continet de Abraham, Ysaac etc. adds V² ; all headings om. N P 2 hoc] primo add D P² 2 tempore om. V² 3 Abraham] de adds P² 3 et Jacob added on top V² ; om. P 3 et filiis om. D 4 eius om. O ; Effraim et Manasse ; de ingressu et adds P² 6 Moyse et Aaron et om. here ; de exitu filiorum Israel is erroneously misplaced, after Syna, all MSS except P² (this is caused by homoioteleuta in the source ; cf. *Introd.*, p. 235)*

1 Apertio eiusdem O only ; Apertio sigilli primi D P², and equally ordinals in all other headings D P² ; all headings om. N P ; Primum tempus ecclesiasticum V² 2 tempore] primo adds D ; primo (tempore) ecclesiastico adds V² 3-4 principium ... agitur (agit D)] evangelium Luce in cuius exordio P²V²P 4 ordine om. D 5 Johanne] Baptista adds P²

Israel de Egypto ; de persecutione
Pharaonis et transitu maris rubri ;
de donatione legis in monte Syna,
de prelatione Moysi et Aaron et
5 XII principibus populi nec non et
LXXII senioribus qui egressi fue-
runt ex Egypto. Sub hoc quoque
tempore acceperunt hereditatem
XII tribus primo quidem V, novis-
10 sime VII. Completa sunt autem
ista omnia a diebus Abrae patriar-
che usque a obitum Josue.

15

20

nativitate quoque Christi et pas-
sione eiusdem et de XII apostolis
primis et ceteris discipulis LXXII.
Similiter et liber Actuum Aposto-
lorum editus ab eodem Luca in
quo et scriptum est de separatione
fidelium a sinagoga Judeorum ; de
adventu spiritus sancti super fide-
les ; de duobus apostolis novissimis
Paulo et Barnaba qui in predica-
tione gentium facti sunt primi usque
ad dormitionem sancti Johannis
Evangeliste. Continetur quoque spe-
cialiter sub ipso prima pars libri
Apocalipsis in qua dicit Johannes
factam sibi revelationem miste-
riorum in dominica die pro eo
scilicet quod tempore resurrectionis
dominice sacra misteria revelari
ceperunt. Sub hoc quoque tempore
fundate sunt quinque principales
ecclesie et alie septem que fuerunt
in Asia de quibus agitur in hac parte.

1-2 persecutione Pharaonis et *om.* *P*²
3 legis] que facta est *add* *V*²*P*
4 prelatione *om.* *O N D* *V*²*P*
4 Moyse *ONDV*²*P* 5 *X* *V*²
6 senioribus] Israel *add* *P*²*V*²*P*; *the*
reference is to the elders of Numbers
11, 16; cf. 'Concordia', f. 12^r for an
explanation of 72 instead of 70 6-7
fuerant *P*² *V*² *P* 7 ex] de *D* *V*² *P*
8 acceperunt *om.* *ON* 9 prime *P*
9 quidem *om.* *V*² 9-10 novissime]
vero *adds* *D* 10 autem *om.* *V*²
11 ista] hec *P*² 11 omnia *om.* *V*²
11-12 patriarche] Jacob *in the margin*
*V*² 12 debitum *P* 12 Josue]
successoris eius *adds* *P*²

1 nativitate ... Christi] ortu Christi
*P*²; ortu eiusdem *V*²*P* 2 eiusdem]
ipsius *V*²*P*; de quo ipso quoque *add*
*P*²*V*²*P* 3 et ceteris] ceterisque
*P*²*V*²*P* 5 editus ab eodem Lu-
ca *om.* *P*² 7 fidelium] et *D*
7 Judeorum *om.* *P*²; sathane *V*²,
satane *D*, sattane *P* 8 spiritus
sancti] scilicet *D* 8-9 super fideles
om. *P*² 11 facti] sancti *P* 11-
13 primi ... Evangeliste *om.* *P*²
13 quoque] sub hoc *adds* *P* 14 sub
ipso *om.* *P*² 14 libri *om.* *V*² 15
quo *D* 15 dicit] sanctus *add*
*P*²*V*²*P* 16-17 misteriorum *om.* *P*
17 in] etiam *P* 19 sacro misterio
D 20 ceperunt] a quo tempore
usque ad persecutionem antichristi
computandi sunt anni MCCLX et
hic incipit tabula concordantie *adds*
*V*²; *to* a quo tempore *is added in*
the margin: scilicet a resurrectione
22 ecclesie] scil. Jerosolimitana, Antio-
chena, Romana, Alexandrina, Con-
stantinopolitana *adds* *P*² 22-23
que ... parte] quas sanctus Johannes
fundavit in Asya *P*²

SECUNDUM SIGILLUM.

Sub hoc secundo tempore continentur pugne filiorum Israel habite cum Chananeis et diversis gentibus
 5 secundum quod scriptum est in gestis Josue et libro Judicum a diebus scilicet Josue usque ad David regem.

10

TERTIUM SIGILLUM.

Sub hoc tertio tempore continentur pugne filiorum Israel habite cum Syris, Philisteis et aliis gentibus
 15 tibus, sive etiam inter Judam et Israel propter scisma quod accidit in diebus Roboam, filii Salomonis, quando Jeroboam, filius Nabath, abstulit sibi X tribus quas et fornica-
 20 cari faciens a Deo suo docuit colere duos vitulos aureos et recedere a domo Domini; nequando inter-

APERTIO EIUSDEM.

Sub hoc secundo tempore continentur prelia paganorum et sanctorum martirum secundum quod specialiter continetur in spiritu in secunda parte Apocalypsis in qua apertis VII signaculis in specie equitum et equorum et aliarum imaginum diversa persecutorum genera sunt ostensa.

APERTIO EIUSDEM.

Sub hoc tertio tempore continentur conflictus catholicorum doctorum habiti cum quibusdam gentibus Arriana perfidia maculatis, Gotis scilicet, Wandalis et Longobardis, sive etiam cum gentibus Persarum. Sed et inter ecclesias Latinorum et Grecorum ac si inter Jerusalem et Samariam dissensio facta est; et perseveravit error Arrianus et alii multi in ecclesiis

1 Secundum tempus moysiaticum *V*²
 4 gentibus *om. P* 6 libris *D P*;
 in libris *V*² 7 scilicet *om. V*²
 14 Syris] et *add D P*² 14 aliis]
 aliquibus *P*² 15 etiam *om. D*
 19 quas *om. V*²*P*

1 Secundum tempus *V*² 2 secundo] quoque *P* 3-4 et sanctorum martirum] sanctorum martirum habita cum paganis *P*²*V*²*P* 5 specialiter *om. P* 5 in spiritu *om. N V*²*P* 7 VII *om. P* 7 sigillis *N V*² 8 aliorum *V*² 9 diversa] universa *D* 9 persecutionum *V*² 10 sunt ostensa] ostensum est *O*; ostensa *om. P*
 11 Tertium tempus *V*² 12 tertio *om. ONP*² 12-13 continetur *V*² 13-14 doctorum *om. D P*²*V*²*P* 14 habitus *V*² 14-15 gentibus *om. D* 15 Arriona *D*; Arriani *O N*; Arianis *P* 16 scilicet] et *D V*² 16 et] atque *D*; *om. P*²*V*²*P* 17 sive *om. P*² 17 gentibus] (gentes, cf. 'Concordia', f. 40^r); gente *P*²*V*²*P* 18 et] etiam *D*; *om. V*² 19 Grecorum ac Latinorum *V*²; et Grecorum *om. P* 22 Arrianorum *V*²*P* 22 et *om. V*² 22 alii multi] alie multe hereses *P*²

fecto eo redirent ad Jerusalem et
ad David, regem suum. Perseve-
ravit autem concertatio ista inter
domum David et domum Joseph
5 ab exordio regni Roboam usque ad
Heliam prophetam, secundum quod
scriptum est in libris Samuelis et
Regum.

10

QUARTUM SIGILLUM.

Sub hoc quarto tempore conti-
nentur gesta Helie et Helisei ducen-
15 tium vitam solitariam et filiorum
prophetarum ducentium vitam
communem quibus etiam ad tem-
pus prefuit Heliseus, sed et pugne
Azael et regis Assyriorum preva-
20 lentium contra filios Israel secun-
dum quod continetur in quarto
Regum volumine a diebus Helie et
Helisei usque ad Ysaïam prophe-
tam et Ezechiam, regem Juda.

25

Grecorum usque in finem, sicut
quondam in Israel usque ad tem-
pora transmigrationis sue, etsi non
defuerunt in eis reliquie sicut et in
tribubus Israel. Continetur autem
conflictus iste quem habuerunt
catholici cum hereticis in tertia
parte Apocalipsis in typo VII
angelorum canentium tubis et di-
versarum rerum imaginibus quod
per singulos angelos ostensum est.

APERTIO EIUSDEM.

Sub hoc quarto tempore clarue-
runt virgines et heremite secundum
quod designatum est in quarta par-
te Apocalipsis in *muliere amicta*
sole fugiente in solitudine sicut
fugit Helias manens uterque ab-
sconditus *in tempus et tempora et*
*dimidium temporis*¹; sed et bella
Saracenorum orta sunt sub hoc tem-
pore quarto secundum quod in
eadem parte quarta ostenditur in
specie bestie ascendentis de abysso
habentis capita VII et cornua X.

1 eo *om.* V² 2 regem] patrem
V² 3 conversatio V²; conturbatio
P 7 est *om.* D 7 libro D
V²P 8 et Regum *om.* V²P
14 gesta *om.* D 16 ducentium
om. D N 17 ad tempus] ab ipso V²
19 regum D V²P 22 diebus] sci-
licet *add* P²P

1 in] ad V² 3 transmigrationis]
captivitatem P² 3 etsi *om.* D;
sic V² 4 in¹ *om.* D P² 4 et
om. P 5 tribus D P 8 typo]
que *adds* D 8 VII] IIII^{or} P²
10 quod] que D P²V²P 11 ostense
sunt P²V²P

12 Quartum tempus V² 13 hoc
om. P 15 designatum] significa-
tum V² 17 sole] et luna sub pedi-
bus eius *adds* V² 17 fugiente]
que fugiit D P; que fugit P²V²
18 fugiit D P² 20 sed] sic V²P
21 sunt *om.* D

1. Cf. *Dan.* 7, 25; 12, 7.

QUINTUM SIGILLUM.

Sub hoc quinto tempore cessa-
verunt prelia Assyriorum datis X
tribubus in manibus eorum et
5 confirmatum est regnum Juda in
manu Ezechie qui et fecit mundari
domum Domini et restauravit officia
levitarum ut quererent Dominum
Deum suum prophetantibus Ysaia,
10 Osea, Michea, Sophonia et Jeremia
et aliis viris sanctis qui effuderunt
phialas iracundie Dei sui super
immundicias populorum a diebus
Ysaie prophete usque ad transmi-
15 grationem Babilonis annunciantes
mala ventura super Judam et
Egyptum et Babilonem et super
multos populos qui erant in fini-
timis regionibus, licet in spiritu
20 non de illis, sed de aliis populis
eisdem similibus loqueretur. Fuit
autem persecutio quinta contra
filios Juda Nechao regis Egypti et
Nabuchodonosor regis Babilonis
25 usque ad transmigrationem Babi-
lonis.

APERTIO EIUSDEM.

Sub hoc quinto tempore confir-
mata est Latina Ecclesia que est
altera Jerusalem, et egressi sunt
ex ea viri spirituales qui zelati
sunt zelo Dei *ad faciendam vin-*
dictam in nationibus et increpationes
*in populis*¹, non quidem gladio ferri,
sed gladio verbi spiritualis, secun-
dum quod continetur in quinta
parte Apocalipsis in typo templi
Domini et angelorum VII egre-
dientium ex eo et effudentium
phialas iracundie Dei in terram ad
excecandas mentes peccatorum qui
morantur in ea iuxta illud Ysaie²:
Exceca cor populi huius, et aures
eius aggrava et oculus eius claude,
ne forte convertatur et sanem eum.
Et sciendum est quod in omnibus
temporibus istis non sunt iidem
termini qui videntur notati in
hac carta simpliciter attendendi,
sed a medietate precedentis tem-
poris iniciatio sequentis atten-
denda est, clarificatio vero in limi-
tibus suis. — Porro tribulatio huius

3 prelia] regum *add V²P* 5 con-
fortatum *V²* 5 Jude *D* 6 et
om. P²P 6-7 mundari ... Domi-
ni] mandata Deo *V²* 9 ysa ac *P*
10 Sophonia *om. P²* 10 et *om.*
P²V²P 11 aliis] multis *adds V²*
12 sui *om. P* 13-14 a... prophete *om.*
P² 14-15 transmigrations *D*
18-19 multos ... regionibus] finitimas
regiones *P²* 20 non ... sed *om.*
P² 20 populis] prophetis *V²*
21 eiusdem *V²* 21 loquerentur
D P² 23 et *om. P²V²P* 24
Babilonis] Caldeorum *P²V²P* 25
transmigrationes *D (cf. l. 14-15)*

1 Quintum tempus *V²* 2 hoc
om. P 4 et *om. V²*; cum *P*
4 congressi *V²* 5 qui] et *add D*
V²P 6-7 faciendas vindictas *D V²P*
9 gladio *om. D P²V²P* 9 verbis
spiritualibus *P* 10 quinta] IIII^a
V² 11 typo *om. D V²P* 11
templo *D V²P* 12 VII] sex *P²*
13 ex] de *P²* 15 obcecandas *P²V²*
P 19 convertantur *O N D P²*
19 eos *O N D P²* 20 est *om. O D*;
Et sciendum est ... limitibus suis *added*
at the foot of both columns P² 21
idem *D P²V²P*; hiidem *N* 22 qui]
supra *adds D* 23 attendendi]
sunt *adds V²* 24 presentis *P²*
25 in inicio *P*

1. *Ps.* 149, 7.2. *Isaiah* 6, 10.

5

SIGILLUM SEXTUM.

Sub hoc sexto tempore continetur transmigratio et percussio Babilonis, necnon et tribulationes duorum filiorum Israel quarum una continetur in historia Judith, altera in libro Hester. Verumtamen templum Dei et muri civitatis reedificati sunt in angustia temporum.

15

20

temporis contra Romanam ecclesiam ac si civilis fuit aliquorum principum mundi et precipue Teutonicorum qui nimis pro peccatis ipsius ecclesiam affligerunt.

APERTIO EIUSDEM.

Sub hoc sexto tempore cepit transmigrare in spiritu spiritualis Jerusalem quousque percucietur nova Babilon, sicut scriptum est in sexta parte Apocalipsis. Revera etenim percucietur et Babilon, populus scilicet qui dicitur Christianus et non est, sed est synagoga sathane, et qui veri sunt Christiani in duabus tribulationibus liberandi sunt, quarum una similis ei quam fecit Holofernes princeps Nabuchodonosor, regis Assyriorum, altera ei quam fecit Aman. Interea tamen multi fidelium coronabuntur martirio et edificabitur rursus sancta

7-8 continetur *V²P* 8 percussio *P²*; persegutio *V²P* 13 Dei] Domini *D* 13-14 reedificati] *re inserted on top O*; edificati *N P²*; hedificati *D V²*; edifficati *P* 14 temporum] in diebus Zorobabel, Hestre, Jhesu(!) et Neemye, sub quibus illa vetus Jerusalem consolationem accepit *adds P²* (*cf. the identical paragraph in the last but one phrase in the 'Apertio', in all other MSS, while P² has only: in diebus Zorobabel*).

2 aliquorum] scilicet *add P²P* 3 mundi *om. P²* 3-4 Teutonicorum qui nimis] Theotonii quorum quidam *V²*; et Normannorum *adds P²* 4 nimis] graviter *P²* 5 ipsius] suis *P²V²P* 5 ecclesiam] eam *P²V²P* 6 Sextum tempus *V²* 8 in spiritu *om. V²* 9 Jerusalem] eritque (*erit et P*) in transmigratione *add P²V²P* 10 nova *om. V²* 10 sicut ... est] secundum quod continetur *P²V²P* 11 parte] libri *add N D* 12 et *om. N D P² V² P* 12 Babilon] nova *adds P* 17 similis] est *adds D*; erit *add P²V²P* 18 Holofernes princeps *om. ND V² P* 18-19 princeps... Assyriorum *om.*, sicut legitur in libro Judith *adds P²* (*cf. the corresponding Sigillum*) 19 rex *N D V²P* 19 Assyriorum] et *add P²P* 20 Aman] quam legitur in libro Hester *adds P²* (*cf. the Sigillum*) 20 tamen *om. P²* 22 rursus *V²*

5

10

SIGILLUM SEPTIMUM.

Sub hoc septimo tempore cessaverunt historia et prophetie et concessus est *sabbatismus*¹ *populo*
 15 *Dei* et reliquiis Judeorum data est pax usque ad Antiochum regem. Qua persecutione peracta non longe post, premissio Johanne, unigenitus Dei Filius venit in mundum, ita

civitas que est ecclesia electorum in angustia temporum sicut factum est in diebus Zorobabel et Josue et Esdre et Nehemie sub quibus vetus illa Jerusalem consolationem accepit. Sed et diabolus qui facit omnia mala hic incarcerationis erit in abyssu ut non seducat amplius gentes usque ad statutum terminum solutionis sue.

APERTIO EIUSDEM.

Sub hoc septimo tempore quod futurum est in proximo cessabunt apertiones signaculorum et labor exponendorum librorum testamenti veteris dabiturque revera *sabbatismus*¹ *populo Dei*, et erit in diebus² illius *iustitia et abundantia pacis et dominabitur Dominus a*

13 hystorie *ND P²V²P* 13 prophete *ND*, i later inserted *O* 14 est *om. D* 15 *Dei*] sed add *ND* 17 qua ... peracta] cuius persecutio quam gravissima fuit cunctas aliorum temporum persecutiones excellens, que in hystoria Machabeorum continetur, qua finita *P²*; peracta *om. V²* 18 *Johanne*] Baptista add *D P²* 18 unigenitus] Christus *P²* 19 ita *om. V²P*

1. *Hebr.* 4, 9.

1 electorum] clericorum *D*; *Dei* add *P²V²P* 3 et *om. P²* (but cf. l. 14 of the *Sigillum*) 3 Josue *om. V²P* 5 consummationem corr. above to consolationem in a thin scribble *O* 6 et *om. N V²P* 6 facit *om. D* 7 hec *P²* 7 erit] est *ND P²*

11 In *V²P* the VIIth opening follows the *OT* seals. *V²* has the heading Septimum tempus ecclesiasticum, part above and part below the passage connected by a fine line on the right, and +.b. in the left margin, referring to a note at the end of the VIIth opening: Quere de VII^o tempore supra proximo ad hoc signum +.b. Septimum supra in principio alterius columpne prece-

dentis (cf. 'Introduction', p. 234) 14 signorum *P²* 15-16 testamenti veteris *om. P²V²P* 16 dabitur *V²*; dabitque *P* 18 eius *D*; illis *P²V²P* 19 et *om. V²* 19 Dominus *om. D V²P*

1. *Hebr.*, 4, 9.

2. *Ps.* 71, 7. 8.

ut in terris¹ videretur et cum hominibus conversaretur.

5

10

15

Consummatis historiis veteris testamenti et passo unigenito Dei Filio qui factus est sub lege, ut eos
20 qui sub lege erant redimeret², advenit tempus resurrectionis in quo et multa corpora sanctorum qui dormierant³ suscitata sunt et collecta in unum turba fidelium, effusa
25 est super illam abundantia pacis

mari usque ad mare¹, et sancti eius regnabunt cum eo usque ad occultum finem ipsius temporis quo solvendus est diabolus de carcere suo et regnaturus est homo ille pessimus qui vocatur Gog, de quo tam multa scripta sunt in libro Ezechielis² prophete. Relinquitur ergo, ut ait Apostolus³, sabbatismus populo Dei in cuius fine futura est tribulatio ista, postquam premissio Helia, venturus est Dominus ad extremum iudicium secundum quod continetur luce clarius in septima parte Apocalipsis in nullo discordans a veteribus signis.

Consummatis operibus testamenti novi et peracta tribulatione illa maxima que erit in diebus Gog, similis quidem illi que facta est sub Antiocho, significata vero in passione Domini, adveniet tempus resurrectionis mortuorum et consolationis superne Jerusalem quam influet ex eo tempore fluvius aque

17 historiis] misteriis P²V²P 20-21 venit V²P 21 resurrectionis] ipsius add P²V²; eius adds P 22-23 dormierant om. P; surrexerunt vel add V²P 24 una V² 25 est om. V²P

1. Baruc 3, 38.
2. Cf. Gal. 4, 4f.
3. Cf. Matth. 27, 52.

2 usque om. V²P 2-3 usque... temporis om. P² 2-3 occultum] occasum V²P 3 temporis] in add P²V²P 4 est om. N 5 suo om. V² 5 est om. O N 6 qui vocatur om. DP²; qui dicitur V² 6 Gog] Antichristus P² 7 tam om. P²V² 7 multa... sunt] legitur P² 8 prophete] sub persona Goc (!) et Magoc (!) adds P² 8-11 Relinquetur P; relinquitur... ista om. P² 11 postquam] persecutionem adds P² 11 premissis P² 12 Helia] et Enoch adds P² 18 novi] scilicet adds V² 20 quidem om. V² 20 que om. D 21 vero] necessario V² 25 influet N D

1. Ps. 71, 7-8.
2. Ezech. 38 f.
3. Hebr., 4, 9.

que et repleta spiritu sancto agno-
vit que sit beatitudo de qua dicit
propheta ¹: *Oculus non vidit, Deus,*
absque te que preparasti diligentibus
5 *te.*

vive secundum quod continetur in
octava parte libri Apocalipsis, et
erit in ea gaudium sempiternum.

2 sit] illa add *P²V²P*

1. Cf. *Is.* 64, 4 ending: *expectanti-*
bus te; see also *I Cor.* 2, 9: *Quod*
oculus non vidit... quae praepravit
Deus iis qui diligunt illum.

Oxford.

2 septima *P* 2 libri om. *P²V²P*
3 sempiternum] Amen add *P²V²P*

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